Pitch Outline

Structure a three-minute pitch in seven parts, rehearse it against the clock, and prepare for the questions that follow.

1. Audience and ask

Who are you pitching to, and what do they care about most?

What exactly are you asking them for?

2. The seven parts

Hook (about 20 seconds): a person, a moment or a striking fact.

Problem and solution (about 50 seconds): who struggles, and what you do about it.

Evidence and model (about 60 seconds): what you have learned and how the venture sustains itself.

Impact, vision and ask (about 50 seconds): the change you create and what you need next.

3. Rehearsal log

Time for each section across five rehearsals.

What did listeners say when you asked them to describe your venture in one sentence?

4. Question preparation

The ten questions you most fear, with a short answer to each.

Your key numbers: customers, revenue, costs and impact measures.

One question you cannot answer yet, and how you would find out.